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Sherwood ALPR Audit Evaluation

Prepared: August 12, 2026

Review period: May 1-July 6, 2026 agency audit exports; July 11-August 9, 2026 public-portal audit; policy effective March 24, 2026

Scope: Evaluation of the supplied Sherwood Police Department ALPR policy, user-audit exports, network-audit exports, and an ARAP analysis of the public search-audit page. This is a records and governance review, not a finding about an individual search, officer, or legal compliance.

Executive conclusion

The records provide unusually valuable visibility into Sherwood's use of Flock, but they do not yet constitute a complete compliance audit. They document local searches, a very large interstate network environment, search reasons, some case references, and a rolling public audit page. They do not establish whether every search was lawful, whether every result was viewed or used, whether every query had a supporting case record elsewhere, or whether required six-month reports and annual audit workpapers exist.

The most important findings are:

1. The three supplied agency user-audit PDFs contain **1,502 distinct displayed search IDs**: 722 for May, 702 for June, and 78 for July 1-6. These corrected counts are based on machine extraction of UUID prefixes from the released PDFs.
2. Many displayed records use descriptive reasons, but the released Case # column is frequently blank or not visibly populated. That does not prove that no case, CAD, or incident record exists elsewhere.
3. The network-audit files are not records of Sherwood employees searching other agencies. Each row identifies an outside organization whose search included the Sherwood network. Inclusion does not establish that a Sherwood image matched, was returned, was viewed, or was used.
4. The May and June network files each contain exactly **1,048,575 data rows**, the maximum number of data rows an Excel worksheet can hold beneath one header. The files therefore cannot be treated as necessarily complete monthly populations without an export manifest, pagination record, or vendor certification.
5. Across the capped May and June exports, more than 92% of rows show searches spanning over 1,000 networks. The partial July export shows the same pattern. This documents the scale of the connected search environment, not improper access.

6. The public audit analysis identifies 185 portal-listed searches from July 11-August 9. All use the generic reason Investigation; 77.8% list more than one network and 56.2% list more than 1,000 networks. The portal alone does not show case numbers, results, or supervisory dispositions.
7. Sherwood's written policy contains strong prohibited-use and hit-verification provisions, but it does not reproduce Arkansas's definite destruction endpoints for records retained beyond 150 days and does not expressly limit interagency sharing to captured data that indicates evidence of an offense.
8. No Sherwood six-month practice-and-usage report or annual audit workpapers were identified in the records assembled for this evaluation. That is a limitation of the current record, not proof that the documents do not exist.

Documents evaluated

Record	Period / date	Evidentiary role
Sherwood PD Policy 11.08.00	Effective March 24, 2026	Written governance requirements
Sherwood user-audit PDF	May 1-31, 2026	Local user searches and lookups
Sherwood user-audit PDF	June 1-30, 2026	Local user searches and lookups
Sherwood user-audit PDF	July 1-6, 2026	Local user searches and lookups
Sherwood network-audit export	May 1-31, 2026	Outside searches that included Sherwood's network
Sherwood network-audit export	June 1-30, 2026	Outside searches that included Sherwood's network
Sherwood network-audit export	July 1-6, 2026	Outside searches that included Sherwood's network
ARAP public-portal search-audit analysis	July 11-August 9, 2026	Analysis of the rolling public audit page

Duplicate filenames in the repository were not counted as separate evidence. The selected policy copies share the same file size and the selected monthly audit copies reproduce the same reporting periods.

User-audit exports

Displayed record counts

Released period	PDF pages	Distinct displayed search IDs
May 1-31	61	722
June 1-30	61	702
July 1-6	7	78
Total	129	1,502

Method: ARAP extracted each PDF's text and counted unique UUID prefixes displayed in the ID column. This avoids treating page headers or wrapped lines as records. The count is reproducible from the released PDFs, but it is not a vendor-certified population count.

Reasons and case linkage

The exports display reasons including investigations involving wanted persons, motor-vehicle theft, welfare checks, drugs/narcotics, burglary, assault, sex offenses, and other categories. Some rows show recognizable case references. Many do not display a value in the Case # column.

That distinction matters. The record supports the statement that a case number is **not visible in the released field for many searches**. It does not support the broader claim that the search lacked a case, CAD, dispatch, or investigative record. A complete audit must reconcile each search ID to the agency's supporting record or document why no case number was required.

The export also distinguishes search, lookup, and mobile variants. Repeated entries can be successive investigative steps rather than duplicate misconduct. A supervisory audit should group related IDs, timestamps, users, plates, and case references before drawing conclusions.

Network-audit exports

Aggregate findings

Metric	May 1-31	June 1-30	July 1-6
Data rows	1,048,575	1,048,575	209,613
Distinct IDs	1,048,575	1,048,574	209,613
Distinct organizations	3,246	3,262	2,378
Median networks searched	2,451	2,398	2,377
Maximum networks searched	7,079	7,133	7,133
Searches over 1,000 networks	966,328 (92.16%)	967,169 (92.24%)	193,641 (92.38%)
Searches over 5,000 networks	324,280 (30.93%)	310,884 (29.65%)	58,698 (28.00%)
Case field blank	606,613	578,051	113,080
Case field shown as ***	441,962	470,524	96,533
convoy search type	2,004	1,958	421

The May and June totals are spreadsheet-capacity warning signs. An .xlsx worksheet has 1,048,576 rows including the header. The May workbook reaches that limit exactly. The June CSV has the same number of data rows, suggesting that its export may also have been limited to an Excel-sized population. At least that many rows were produced; completeness cannot be assumed.

Meaning of a network row

The network export's Org Name is the organization associated with the search. The fact that the row appears in Sherwood's network audit means Sherwood's network was included in the search scope. It does **not**, by itself, show:

- that a Sherwood camera returned a matching image;
- that the searcher viewed or downloaded Sherwood data;
- that Sherwood approved that individual search;
- that the search produced an enforcement action; or
- that the search was unlawful.

The records nevertheless demonstrate why standing network access requires auditable rules. A meaningful access audit needs query scope, actual result sources, views, downloads, exports, temporary access, requesting agency, assisting agency, legal purpose, case linkage, and disposition.

Reason categories

The network exports contain both specific and general reasons. Traffic-related text appears in 104,690 May rows, 100,397 June rows, and 18,968 July rows. Those totals are category-string counts, not proof that Sherwood data was used for traffic enforcement. The rows originate with many outside agencies and merely show that Sherwood's network was included.

Public audit page

The preserved ARAP analysis of the rolling public page reports:

Metric	July 11-August 9, 2026
Portal-listed searches	185
Displayed reason	Investigation for all 185
More than one network	144 (77.8%)
More than 1,000 networks	104 (56.2%)
Median networks searched	2,402
Maximum networks searched	6,295

The public page is useful but too generalized for independent compliance review. Investigation does not identify the offense, case, requesting agency, legal predicate, result, or disposition. A public portal can protect sensitive details while still providing controlled reason categories, audit period, total queries, exception counts, and certification methodology.

Policy assessment

Sherwood Policy 11.08.00 includes several meaningful safeguards:

- visual and ACIC/NCIC confirmation before enforcement based on an alert;
- a detailed list of prohibited personal, discriminatory, harassment, immigration-only, and minor-traffic uses;
- documented hit dispositions;
- annual audits with findings retained for three years; and
- six-month public statistical reporting preserved for eighteen months.

The principal textual gaps are:

1. **Extended retention.** The policy permits retention beyond 150 days for an investigation or prosecution but does not state Arkansas's two definite destruction events: the conclusion of an investigation without charges or the conclusion of the related criminal action.
2. **Sharing threshold.** The policy allows sharing with authorized law-enforcement agencies but does not expressly state that the captured plate data must indicate evidence of an offense.
3. **Query documentation.** The policy describes audit review of query justification but does not plainly require a contemporaneous case/CAD number or documented exception for every historical search.
4. **Audit frequency and method.** Annual review is less frequent than the monthly or quarterly controls found in some peer policies. The policy does not state the sample size, population, or exception-handling method.

What the records do and do not establish

Established by the supplied records

- Sherwood had a written ALPR policy effective March 24, 2026.
- User and network audit exports exist for the identified 2026 periods.
- Local searches display reasons and sometimes case references.

- Outside organizations conducted large numbers of network searches that included Sherwood’s network.
- The public portal presents limited aggregate search information.

Not established by the supplied records

- That every network row returned or exposed Sherwood data.
- That a blank released case field means no supporting case exists.
- That every recorded search was proper or improper.
- That the May and June network exports are complete.
- That required six-month reports or annual audits were not prepared.
- That policy requirements were followed in every individual event.

Focused follow-up records

1. Every Sherwood six-month practice-and-usage report for the full statutory preservation period, including the underlying native datasets.
2. Annual audit memoranda, workpapers, population counts, sample selections, exceptions, corrective actions, and approvals.
3. A vendor export manifest showing total monthly network rows, pagination, truncation, and export timestamps.
4. A data dictionary defining search, lookup, convoy, Total Networks Searched, Reason, Case #, Filters, and moderation fields.
5. Query-to-case reconciliation for a defensible sample, including documented exceptions when no case number is required.
6. Logs showing which network queries actually returned Sherwood results and whether those results were viewed, downloaded, exported, or shared.
7. Sharing-setting histories, outside-agency authorization records, temporary-access records, and supervisory approvals.
8. The written rule implementing Arkansas’s destruction deadlines for data retained beyond 150 days.

Bottom line

Sherwood’s production is sufficient to document scale and identify concrete governance questions, but not to certify compliance or prove misuse. The strongest next step is a reproducible administrative audit that reconciles search IDs to supporting records, separates network inclusion from actual data access, confirms export completeness, tests sharing and retention controls, and publishes a public summary with population, sample, exceptions, and corrective actions.

Authority and source integrity

- Arkansas Act 668 of 2025, amending Arkansas Code §§ 12-12-1803 through 12-12-1805.
- Sherwood Police Department, Policy 11.08.00, effective March 24, 2026.
- 5_1_2026-5_31_2026-Sherwood AR PD-Audit_Locked-Redacted.pdf.
- 6_1_2026-6_30_2026-Sherwood AR PD-Audit_Locked-Redacted.pdf.
- 7_1_2026-7_6_2026-Sherwood AR PD-Audit_Locked-Redacted.pdf.
- Corresponding May, June, and July network-audit exports.
- ARAP-SHERWOOD-PORTAL-PUBLIC-SEARCH-AUDIT-20260711-20260809-H065_ANALYSIS.xlsx.

Selected source-file SHA-256 values are maintained in the accompanying evidence manifest. Original source files should remain unchanged; public reproductions should redact plate, person, and authentication data where appropriate.

This report is a records and governance analysis, not legal advice or a finding of misconduct.